Abdullah Al Zahid

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Human Resources
Office of the Chief Administrative Officer
City of North Vancouver, North Vancouver, BC

Re: Manager, Geographic Information Systems (GIS)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Manager, Geographic Information Systems position in the Office of the Chief Administrative Officer. I am a transportation engineer and an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, where much of my work is building and maintaining the spatial data the section relies on.

I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets Transportation Planning depends on, using GIS and Python, including a right-of-way width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript. I also built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which combined several years of survey data into one validated source the division reports from. The posting describes a working manager who contributes directly to technical delivery, and hands-on technical work is where I am strongest.

My master's thesis used GIS and macro-simulation to assess community transportation capacity for wildfire evacuation. At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not led a GIS team or supervised GIS specialists and technicians, and I have not administered ArcGIS Enterprise, ArcGIS Online or field data collection tools, or used FME. My master's degree is in transportation engineering rather than GIS or geography, though my thesis was GIS-based. I am applying because the spatial data and automation at the centre of the role is the work I do now.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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